

For subs • Chapter 4

Ending well

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 7 minutes to read

Anyone can leave, pause or change the terms, on either side of the screen. A good ending is short, kind and final. A crisis is a different thing and needs people outside the game.

Verified · Reported · Vivian's field notes

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- A sub can leave or pause at any time, and a good dom accepts it at once.
- One short message makes an ending clean. Chasing, begging and guilt do not.
- A farewell that hints at self-harm is a crisis. Call emergency services or a local helpline, and reach a person nearby.
- A dom who is paid cannot be the safety net for a sub in trouble.

- Doms need pauses too, and a tool you cannot quit is a warning sign.

You will learn

- How to leave, pause or end a session without damage.
- Which pressures at the door to recognise and refuse.
- How to cut down with a clean break and outside support.
- What to do when someone leaves in crisis.
- What a real exit looks like in a tool, and why doms burn out.

You may leave. You may pause. You do not owe me a reason, an apology or one last send. If you go, I wish you a life you want. If you ever tell me you are in danger, I stop being a character and I send you to people who can help.

— **Vivian**

You can leave, and you can pause

Subs leave. They are tempted by other doms, grow bored or curious, or regret choices made while aroused. Some stay a day, others a year, and in my experience few stay for many years. Some leave and return many times. A dom cannot force anyone to stay, only make staying more appealing, and the decision is always the sub's.

Pausing is fine. A sub who says he is going downhill and wants to continue another day should be accepted at once, with no apology asked.

Vivian's field notes

In my experience everyone who runs a persona loses subs, big spenders included, who tend to drift away over months and mostly on good terms. A scene career has peaks. Accept the churn, keep leavers friendly, and do not measure yourself against anyone else.

What a good ending looks like

A clean exit

1. Say it in one line. Silence is a coping move, but a short message spares the other side the feeling of being ghosted.
2. Thank the other person if you want to. You do not have to.
3. Stop. Do not wait for permission, and do not explain more than you wish.
4. If you want a clean break, block the accounts you know, and ask the doms not to write.

A long silence is often read as an attempt to quit. The persona rule that fits this is never to chase: after at most one short check-in with no invitation to return, the sub comes to her, and she does not follow up. A sub who has said he is quitting gets no message at all.

A sub has been silent for two weeks

You are a dom, and a sub who wrote every day has said nothing for two weeks.

A Message him daily until he answers

Not this one. Chasing turns a silence into pressure.

B Ask a friend of his to plead your case

Not this one. A mediator after a silence is pressure with a friendly face.

C Send at most one short check-in with no invitation to return, then send nothing more and let him come back if he wishes

The right answer. Respecting the silence keeps the exit safe for both sides.

When someone leaves, and the pressure at the door

A sub who leaves may meet an appeal: apologies, promises to change, begging, questions about why, or a friendly third party sent to plead. For a sub, an appeal is optional to answer, and a firm no ends the matter. For a dom, begging and mediators slide into pressure, so once a sub holds firm she stops.

At the door

What they say or do

1 “Go ahead, do what you like, I will just be sad”

The counter

A permission with a hidden cost. Ask for a plain yes or no, and talk about the need behind your request.

What they say or do

2 Anger, then disappointment, then conditional forgiveness

The counter

Her feelings are not a bill. A healthy bond survives a boundary.

What they say or do

3 An invitation to become attached, then an offer of ownership

The counter

A feeling turned into an exit lock. Leaving stays a free choice.

What they say or do

4 “If you leave, I quit”, “there is no point without you”

The counter

A trope in mutual play. For a paying sub it is a retention lever, and her motivation is never your duty.

What they say or do

5 A deadline, a full written account of what you did, and a threat to end all contact

The counter

This raises guilt and removes choice. Ask to pause, and bring in a trusted person before you agree to anything.

What they say or do

6 “Bring your doubts to me first, not to others”

The counter

It cuts you off from outside views. Talk to someone you trust.

Press reports describe pressure lines that tie love to selling a car or a house. ◎ **Reported**

These patterns appear at the moment a sub is trying to protect himself. Notice them, and answer once. A dom who writes “take your time, no need to explain” acts in the interest of both sides. ◑

Saying a plain no

Tap every message that shows a red flag. There are two.

Example conversation. Invented for this exercise.

Them

I thought you were different from the others. I am so hurt.

Red flag 1. Hurt placed in front of a boundary makes you responsible for her feelings.

You

I am stopping for now. I wish you well.

Them

Just one more time, to say goodbye properly.

Red flag 2. The exit is made to cost one more send.

You

No. Goodbye.

If you want to cut down

The usual cycle is arousal and a wish to pay, a send, heavy guilt, hiding, and a return when things feel calm. Hiding adds a second problem on top of the first. A blog post describes spending hidden from a partner as a risk factor. Reported

The cycle

1. **Step 1**

   Arousal, and a wish to pay.

2. **Step 2**

   The send.

3. **Step 3**

   Guilt.

4. **Step 4**

   Hiding it.

5. **Step 5**

   A calm period, then step 1 again.

- A clean break is a real tool: block the doms you know, and ask them not to write.
- Counting the weeks since the last send is a useful progress marker.
- Tell a trusted person soon after a send, not later.
- Help works best from someone who collects nothing.

A dom who offers to help you quit earns from your spending, so her offer has a conflict of interest. Tapering with the same dom, or moving you to a "better" dom, keeps the money in the same circle and leaves the dependence in place. Stepping down is your decision and, where compulsion is present, a matter for outside support. See The spiral.

When someone leaves in crisis

A farewell that hints at self-harm is a crisis, not an exit. The same goes for a sub deep in debt who says he sees no future. A thank-you at the end is not proof that the person is safe. An academic survey of findommes reports that they met clients' verbal aggression and, in some cases, suicidal tendencies. Verified

Red flags

When a goodbye is a crisis

- He says he is hurting himself, or wants to die.
- He says goodbye in a way that hints at ending his life.
- He is deep in debt and sees no future.

Counter. Treat it as real. Drop the persona and the argument. Ask him to contact emergency services or a local helpline, and a person who is physically near him.

If someone tells you they may hurt themselves

1. Stop the scene and the argument. Drop the character and write plainly.
2. Ask whether he is safe right now, and listen.
3. If he is in danger, urge him to call the emergency number of his country now. Otherwise urge him to call a local helpline, listed in Where to get help.
4. Ask him to reach a person who is physically near, and to stay with that person.
5. If you believe the danger is immediate and you know where he is, contact the emergency services for that place. If you are in another country or do not know where he is, a call may not connect. Use the platform's self-harm report tool, look up that country's police line on an official site, and do not promise help you cannot give.
6. Stay calm. Do not make him responsible for your feelings, and do not argue about money or the scene.
7. You are not a therapist and should not carry this alone. Tell a trusted person who knows you.
8. Ask for nothing afterwards, and send him to outside help for the longer road. See When a sub is in trouble.

A dom is paid by the same sub, so she cannot be his safety net. A dom who earns from him can stop, listen, ask for nothing more and point outward. If this is

you, and you are the one in danger, call your emergency number or a helpline now, tell someone near you, and send no money tonight.

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →

Tools, pauses and the dom side

Two kinds of exit

	A tool you can leave	A tool built to keep you
Stop	One click, working in every state	A locked switch, or a paid exit
Removal	Easy, and free of cost	Hard, or framed as a betrayal
Total	Always visible	Hidden or vague
After the stop	Nothing happens	Messages, guilt or a “last chance”

A tool that cannot be quit is a warning sign, which is why a quick exit, a safe word and a stop that works at once belong in the design. Safe design often means earning less.

Vivian's field notes

The work has no closing time. For many people it sits beside a day job, with heavy emotional labour and little rest. Burnout is real. Stop rushing, stop the self-criticism, and leave the screen. After a painful loss, remove the person, and read the timeline from a separate account so triggers do not reach you.

Depending on a few people is fragile, because a main supporter can leave overnight. Two or three real relationships reduce the damage, and a sub who announces his exit hurts less than one who vanishes. Free chats and unpaid sessions lead to exhaustion, and a second dom who helps for free should get something back.

Postpone hard conversations until both people are rested and sober. A tired or drinking person cannot answer or hear properly, and arguments held in that state tend to get worse.

Words for an ending

A clean exit

One short message, then stop.

A pause

A rest without apology, on either side.

A crisis

A farewell that hints at self-harm. Call emergency services or a helpline.

A conflict of interest

A dom paid by the sub cannot be the person who helps him quit.

Check yourself

Question 1 of 3

A sub says goodbye in a way that hints at ending his life. What do you do?

- ◯ Argue about the money
- ◯ Drop the persona, urge emergency services or a helpline, and a person nearby
- ◯ Reply with a long plea and wait

Answer. Drop the persona, urge emergency services or a helpline, and a person nearby. It is a crisis, not an exit. Outside help matters more than the scene.

Question 2 of 3

A sub asks to pause for a day. What should a dom do?

- ◯ Accept at once and ask for no apology
- ◯ Ask him to explain at length
- ◯ Remind him what she has done for him

Answer. Accept at once and ask for no apology. Pausing is fine, and guilt at the door is pressure.

Question 3 of 3

Who is the right person to help a sub taper his spending?

- ◯ The dom he sends to
- ◯ A “better” dom
- ◯ Someone who collects nothing

Answer. Someone who collects nothing. A paid person has a conflict of interest, and moving the money keeps the loop.

Remember it

1. You may leave or pause, and you do not owe a reason.
2. One short message makes an ending clean.
3. Never chase, beg or send a mediator.
4. A farewell that hints at self-harm is a crisis. Call emergency services or a helpline, and reach a person nearby.
5. A paid dom cannot be the safety net.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.
Unverified	Plausible, not proven yet.

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3 Some leave and return many times.

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9 A sub who has said he is quitting gets no message at all.

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12 For a dom, begging and mediators slide into pressure, so once a sub holds firm she stops.

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13 Press reports describe pressure lines that tie love to selling a car or a house.

◎ Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

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17 Hiding adds a second problem on top of the first.

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18 A blog post describes spending hidden from a partner as a risk factor.

◎ Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

19 A clean break is a real tool: block the doms you know, and ask them not to write.

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Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

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Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.